Abdullah Al Zahid

Toronto, ON | (780) 982-3680 | azahid1@ualberta.ca | linkedin.com/in/abdullah-al-zahid

October 22, 2026

Hiring Manager
Capital Project Delivery
Metrolinx

Re: Senior Project Manager, Hamilton LRT

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to be considered for the Senior Project Manager position on the Hamilton LRT Project. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, with a master's degree in transportation engineering, and I worked at Metrolinx in 2023. I am writing knowing that this is a delivery role at a much more senior level than mine.

At the City I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations. I plan the work, hold the schedule, and report progress to the people relying on it, while coordinating divisions, consultants and outside agencies whose priorities do not always line up. I review development applications and the studies filed with them, and I write the briefing notes that carry issues and options to senior staff. At Mott MacDonald I worked on Ontario Line construction staging and ran traffic simulations of the road closures it required. At Metrolinx I simulated GO rail operations in OpenTrack and assessed what construction-related slow orders do to service.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not managed the design, procurement, construction or commissioning of a transit project. I have not administered contracts, managed contractors or a project budget, or led a team of project professionals, and I am not familiar enough with the Occupational Health and Safety Act or the Professional Engineers Act to claim working knowledge of them. I do not hold a P.Eng. I am applying because the coordination, scheduling and stakeholder work is close to what I do now, and because I would like to move toward delivering transit rather than only planning it.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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